

step due to the need for information navigation tools in response to the rapid increase in research production and information accumulation. However, the pressure to produce and be seen as productive raises questions about what productivity truly means and the integrity of academic work. While AI is an effective tool for measuring productivity, our data supports the continued need for human judgement in decision making. Focusing solely on efficiency and productivity may weaken the quality of research output and obscure the use of human judgement to produce unexpected interpretations of data and literature, ultimately leading to deleterious consequences for individual and epistemic identities. It is important to note that AI cannot replace emotional and nuanced judgement, particularly in research evaluation roles. As such, the tension between research quality and productivity is a critical issue for researchers, research leaders, and funders to address.



The integration of AI in information navigation and knowledge production can be highly advantageous, particularly in the daily practices of researchers for web searches and communication technologies. It can facilitate connections between researchers and potentially promote interdisciplinary collaboration.

However, some interviewees expressed concern that this may lead to a trend of generalism among academics, detracting from expertise in specific areas. While the impact agenda requires increased public engagement and interaction, it may be more beneficial to promote accessible specialisms